Around the World in a Bad Mood!

By Renee Foss

NOTE: Words appearing in [ ] are added as transitional items.

FLIGHT ATTENDANT (FA): Good morning, ladies and gentlemen! In a few moments we'll begin the breakfast service in the main cabin. We have a wide selection of choices for you today. You may have any or all of the following items: Prozac, Zoloft, Viagra, Ecstasy, Ritalin, Cele-brex, or scrambled eggs. Some of these items may cause side effects, such as dry mouth, fatigue, internal bleeding, temporary blindness; and leprosy. Again, your choices include Prozac, Zoloft, Viagra, Ecstasy, Ritalin . . . oh, one moment please. My apologies, ladies and gentlemen, that is the *flight attendants'* breakfast menu!

(to audience) I am a flight attendant and the world is my oyster. And what an oyster it is! Oversold flights, weather delays, air traffic control delays, center seats, crappy food, air rage - it's so glamorous! Kind of like a Greyhound bus in the sky. This is just a glimpse into my life . . . a story about air travel, flight attendants, and me!

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So . . . fasten your seat belts, raise your tray table, and stow your bag . . . The journey is about to begin. Welcome to my nightmare!

INTRODUCTION

Around the World in a Bad Mood! Confessions of a Flight Attendant by Rene Foss

**WIRT – What I'm Really Thinking*

FA: Welcome aboard, sir, so glad you could join us today. You have seat 4B. Get you a gin and tonic? My pleasure.

WIRT: Pleasure, my a**. I'd rather watch paint dry.

FA: Here you go, sir. Oh, you couldn't find room for your carryon? You're tired of lifting it and you want someone to get it out of your way?

WIRT: And I guess I'm the lucky someone. I cannot believe my good fortune. Jesus, what has he got in here? A dead body? If this six-foot, 200-pound bruiser can't lift it, how does he possibly think I can lift it?

FA: You know, sir, I think this bag is a little big for the overhead. Perhaps I could check it to your final destination?

WIRT: Better yet, perhaps I could check ***you*** to your final

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destination and put the bag in your seat. The bag would probably be a lot more interesting.

FA: Unacceptable, you say?

WIRT: I'll tell you what's unacceptable: your personality! He probably thinks just because he's sitting in first class that he's entitled to be rude to everyone in the world. Well, I'm checking this bag, whether Mr. Congeniality likes it or not. *(begins dragging it up the aisle)*

FA: Oh, I didn't mean to disturb you . . . Yes, well, it looks like the only available option is to check it. It sort of exceeds the size requirements.

WIRT: A little bit like your ego, pal. Oh boy, he's getting up now. Well, that got him into action! Probably hasn't moved that fast in years. My, my, look at those muscles .... Amazing how he can heave that two-ton bag into the overhead. Just 2 minutes ago he didn't have the strength.

FA: Thanks so much for helping with ***your*** bag. I'm glad we didn't have to check it . . . My name?

WIRT: My name . . . what does he want my name for? It's not like we're going to be buddies. In fact, if things work out the way I am hoping we will never see each other again. So why on God's green earth does he need to know

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my name? He's probably going to write me up. *(outraged)* I'm just doing my job, risking my chiropractic good health trying to help this brute with his bag. And what do I get? This idiot requesting my name. Maybe I'll just make up a name . . .

FA: Oh no, you don't need to apologize. I'm sure you've had a hard day and having to tow that heavy bag of yours around has got to be tiring. . .

WIRT: I'll give you a hard day ... my day! Five stops between Chicago and Indianapolis, airplanes of people just like this jack***. And I've got to do the same thing tomorrow and the next day, too. What did I ever do to deserve this? God, I hate my life.

FA: Tonight? Well, I'm flattered. . . Oh yes, I'm sure there's a lot of great nightlife, but I really have to get to bed early tonight because I have to wake up at 7:00 A.M. Oh, aren't you funny, you won't take no for an answer . . .

WIRT: Oh, he's funny all right. Funny as a crutch.

FA: . . . . I guess as long as I'm back by a reasonable hour -- why not? I accept, sir. Charlie? OK, Charlie. I'm really looking forward to it.

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WIRT: I'm looking forward to it about as much as I'm looking forward to paying my taxes or getting a root canal.

FA: I'll be right back!

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FA: *(to audience)* And there you are . . . curled up in a little ball, sucking your thumb, on the verge of uncontrollable sobbing, when the captain makes an announcement:

CAPTAIN: Ladies and gentlemen, I have some bad news: It appears we will be here for at least another hour. Please let us know if there's anything we can do to make you more comfortable. Thank you." . . . .

FA: ARGGHHHH!!

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NEW FA: TESTING, ONE-TWO-THREE . . . hello? Is this thing on? Oh, for Christ's sake OK. Welcome aboard We Apologize for This Inconvenience Airlines, also known as WAFTI. This flight is under the command of Captain Booze, assisted by First Officer Chance, and as we like to say here at WAFTI, if Booze and Chance can't get ya there . . . nothing can!

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For your comfort we have four lavatories on this aircraft: one in first class and three in coach. However, only one is working, so pace yourself! The airphones are not working, we have only three pillows and two blankets. We do not have any magazines or newspapers, but we do have the pamphlet How *to Deal with Anger in a Positive Non-violent Way.* Today we will be passing these pamphlets out in lieu of the meals. We here at WAFTI appreciate your business and we want you to know that we're constantly upping our standards . . . So up yours!

Now it is time for the safety demonstration. This information could save your life so please pay attention! It's time for the 'Safety Demo Shuffle.' *(Attendant raps and moves to the beat, the more awkward the better . . . with enthusiasm!)*

SAFETY DEMO SHUFFLE

If you've never traveled by car
this is your seat belt, please know where they are.
To fasten the belt, just pull till it's tight
and don't let go till the end of the flight!
This is for safety, especially yours,
pay close attention as we point out the doors,

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please keep in mind this aircraft has eight,
they all have slides and we hope they inflate.
If we have to get out, there won't be much time,
so head for the door and follow in line,
should the cabin lose pressure, place this mask on your nose,
if the plane's going down, just reach for your toes,
if we have a water evacuation,
use your tushy cushion for your flotation,
pull up and remove, then hold to your chest,
dive in the water, and hope for the best!
A few more reminders, then off on our way:
No smoking, no cell phones, no meals today!
Thank you for flying, we're glad to arrive.
If you want to get there faster,
if you want to get there sooner,
if you just want to get there
why don't you drive???
We doooooooo!!!!!

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FA: Hello, can I get you a beverage?

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PASSENGER: Yes, I'll have a can of tomato juice, a bottle of water, and two cups of coffee with cream and sugar.

FA: Are you ordering for the whole row?

PASSENGER: No, just for me . . . I'm kind of thirsty.

FA: Anything else?

PASSENGER: Yeah, now that you mention it, I'll have a can of apple juice for later.

FA: Airline food has been the butt of many jokes over the years. People make fun of its quality, color, taste (or lack thereof), but as soon as you take it away people miss it! People **used** to complain about the food choices we offered:

PASSENGER: All you have are three choices?! And all of them terrible! My God, what is the world coming to?

FA: Then as we incurred some cutbacks and started giving everyone the same meal, people were downright appalled.

PASSENGER: You mean everyone is getting the chicken? This is horrifying, I can't believe I don't have a choice!

FA: *(to passenger)* But, you do have a choice: eat or don't. *(to audience)* Now, as cost-cutting measures continue, we have not only eliminated the choice, but on certain flights

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we've eliminated the meal service altogether. ***Airlines are in the transportation business, not the restaurant business!*** As a passenger you are paying for ***transport*** from here to there, not for the bologna sandwich that we throw in your face. When the airline tells you they'll be serving a five-course meal, it means an apple, a granola bar, cheese, crackers, and a mint in a paper bag. . . The last thing I'd like to remind people is that the flight attendants, just like waiters, are the last ones to touch your food or beverage before you consume it. Keep this in mind at all times and *bon appetit!*

NEW FLIGHT ATTENDANT: *(end of the flight)* We here at WAFTI appreciate your business and we want you to know that we're constantly upping our standards . . . So up yours! Buh bye!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2005 National Qualifier
2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

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